

lytism (spoken of more fully elsewhere) is here in point. While, of course, this proselytism is in behalf of foreign cults, it yet indicates an intense religious interest and influence, scarcely conceivable apart from her share in the cultic life.

Neither may we pass over lightly such expressions as Ruth's **וַאֲלֹהֵי אֱלֹהֵי**. It was hardly an empty phrase. If it may be taken, as well it ought to be, and as is so generally done, as an evidence of the early conception of the close union of the god with his land, the personal pronouns are an equally strong indication of woman's share in the religious life.

4. Woman's Relation to the Jahveh Cult as affected by Some Ritualistic Legislation.

1. *The Female in Sacrificial Victims.*

According to the researches of W. R. Smith, a very vital principle underlies the selection of the sacrificial animal, which determines not only the species of the animal but also its sex.³⁹ It is therefore not without meaning to our inquiry to note whether the sacrificial animal in the Hebrew cult was limited to the male.⁴⁰ We should expect that a cult that proscribes woman on account of her sex would also not permit the use of a female victim in sacrifice. But that the latter is not the case in the Hebrew cult is very evident. In earlier practice the female victim predominates (Gen. 15⁹ [E] 1 S. 6^{1c} 16²). In the Levitical legislation a discrimination is made in favor of the male in that it is preferred in the more solemn sacrifices, but even there the female victim is by no means excluded. A male is required as a passover-lamb (Ex. 12⁵), for the **עֹלָה** (Lev. 1^{3.10} 22¹⁹); in the **הַטָּהַר** a male is required from an "anointed priest" (Lev. 4³), from the whole people (vs.¹⁴), from the ruler (vs.²³), while in the case of an ordinary Israelite a female is accepted (vs.^{28.32} and 5⁶); in the **שְׁלָמִים** the victim may be either male or female (Lev. 3^{1.6}; cf. Mal. 1¹⁴). I defer the discussion of the reason for this discrimination; for the present, let it suffice to mention this as simply another fact pointing to the conclusion that the Hebrew cult is not pervaded by any principle that excludes the female sex.

2. *Woman as ceremonially "defiling."*

Both the sexual approach to woman and her condition in childbed or during her courses are regarded in Hebrew custom and legislation,

³⁹ *Rel. of Sem.*, Lecture viii.

⁴⁰ As was the case among the Harranians, quoted by W. R. Smith, p. 280, note 2.